

SENATE BILL 1480

By Lowe

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 38,
Chapter 7, relative to autopsies.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 38-7-109(b), is amended by deleting the subsection and substituting instead:

(b) When an autopsy is ordered by the district attorney general, the county medical examiner shall notify the chief medical examiner, and the county medical examiner may perform the autopsy or shall designate and authorize a pathologist to perform the autopsy as provided in § 38-7-105. The costs and expense of the autopsy must be paid by this state as other costs, chargeable to the state, are paid.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.